

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in special session on Monday, September 22, 2025 at 4:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia L. Perry.

Absent: None.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom.

Commissioner Charisse Fain gave the invocation.

The purpose of the special meeting was to consider a 5% county match for the school's capital needs grant applications, consider an extension to the detention center's emergency pay policy, and hold the Opioid Settlement Funds Annual Meeting.

Schools Capital Needs Grant. Finance Director Stephanie Williams noted that during the board's September regular meeting, Superintendent Cindy Bennett presented information on an opportunity to apply for a \$47.2M capital needs grant with the NC Department of Public Instruction for 14 school facilities. The board agreed to allow staff to review the applications and the county's fund balance and bring back to the board during this meeting. Ms. Williams noted that state law requires the county to provide a 5% local match. If all grant applications are approved, this would total \$2.35M over five years. The match would come from the School Capital Reserve Fund which is supported by local sales taxes and accrued capital funds. The staff recommendation is to approve the 5% local match.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve the 5% local match to be paid over five years. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain and unanimously approved.

Detention Center Emergency Pay Policy Extension. County Manager C. Renee Perry noted that during the board's September regular meeting, Sheriff Curtis Brame and Major Gregory Petrina, Jr. requested an extension of the Detention Center Emergency Pay Policy through December 31. The board agreed to allow staff to review the policy and bring back a

recommendation to the board during this meeting. Ms. Perry provided a revised policy with the following changes:

- The policy applies only to non-exempt Sheriff's Office/Detention Center employees with a pay grade of 72 or below who are authorized to work additional hours at the detention center.
- Instead of \$50/hour, eligible employees will receive their regular hourly rate, plus regular overtime rate.
- All emergency assignments must be pre-approved by the Sheriff in writing and submitted to the county manager and finance director for a pre-audit prior to hours worked and payment.
- No one employee shall exceed 60 hours per pay period.
- The finance office will maintain records of all emergency pay activity for compliance review.
- Transportation of inmates shall be handled by patrol deputies on regular shift without additional pay unless it causes undue hardship on Sheriff's Office operations. In instances of undue hardship, the Sheriff shall request approval from the county manager with supporting documentation.
- The policy is temporary and will remain in effect until lapsed salary funds are fully expended.
- The policy will automatically terminate once funds are no longer available and will not be automatically reinstated if lapsed salaries accrue over a period of time.
- If staffing challenges persist, the board may consider an extension or alternative measures.

Sheriff Curtis Brame appeared before the board and expressed his concerns with the current revisions. He stated that it is not feasible for on-duty deputies to transport inmates throughout the state, and that as Sheriff, he does not need prior approval or permission to do anything. He also disagreed with the 60-hour cap per pay period.

The board discussed the need for an improved relationship between the Sheriff and the District Attorney, the need for more organization at the detention center, and the need for better management of the emergency pay policy. They also expressed concerns with burnout of employees working too many overtime hours.

Following further discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve the revised Emergency Pay Policy as presented. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain and vote was ayes - six (6); noes - one (1), with the dissenting vote being cast by Commissioner Valencia L. Perry.

Opioid Settlement Funds Annual Meeting. The NC Memorandum of Agreement requires that each county receiving opioid settlement funds hold at least one annual meeting open to the public and invite all incorporated municipalities in the county to attend. The meeting was advertised, and Vance County municipalities were invited to attend, but none were in attendance.

County Manager C. Renee Perry noted that, to date, Vance County has received \$2,402,285 and will receive \$6.4M by the end of 2038. She presented graphs highlighting Vance County

emergency department visits for opioid overdoses, fentanyl deaths in Vance County, and the North Carolina schedule of estimated payments to Vance County.

She stated that the memorandum of understanding offers local governments two options and noted that Vance County has chosen Option A. See options below:

- Option A: a local government may fund one or more strategies from a shorter list of evidence-based, high impact strategies to address the epidemic
- Option B: a local government may fund one or more strategies from a longer list of strategies after engaging in a collaborative strategic planning process involving a diverse array of stakeholders

The board then opened the floor for public comments regarding opioid settlement funds. Elliot Clark, Vaya Health, commended the board for establishing an advisory committee to address the use of settlement funds. Public Health Director Lisa Harrison stated that the health department sees patients facing opioid addiction every day. She also stated that a treatment center is a high need in this area. Cheryl Bateman, Rebecca Neal, and Nikki Robinson with Recovery Alive stated that recovery ministries are being developed to help those struggling with addiction and thanked the board for taking a stand for our people. Shanekia Hargrove with Vance Recovery also thanked the board for all that is being done to address opioid addiction.

At this time, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to enter into closed session to discuss a personnel matter.

Upon return to open session, and as there was no further business, at 5:10 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed October 6, 2025.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair